



From Me to (R)U

*"By College Students, For
College Students"*

rupawning.com

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Description of your Business Concept

Our organization focuses on convenience, ease-of-use, and authenticity—things that other similar services, such as Facebook Marketplace, doesn't have. Services such as Facebook Marketplace or other online pawn shops have goods that are too far away. With our organization being placed on campus, every student will have access to these products even without a car (The buses provide enough transportation across all campuses). Additionally, services such as eBay or Facebook Marketplace are considered older platforms for many. This service will be catered by Rutgers students for Rutgers students, providing products that consumers know are real and worthy.

Customer Value Proposition

“By college students, For college students”

Convenient access (all on campus)

More student orientated

Make the website extremely easy

Creates a trustworthy environment—Safer and cheaper than other competitors



Vision Statement, Mission Statement, Statement of Core Values

Vision statement: Become the first place students go to look for affordable goods

Our **mission** is to serve students by offering fair and transparent pawn and resale services for authentic everyday items such as electronics, textbooks, and personal goods. We aim to provide short-term financial support and affordable purchasing.

Some **core values** our organization will focus on is the trust we place with our consumers, the authenticity of our products, and our cause-related marketing techniques to ensure the greatest customer satisfaction and value. We will create a trustworthy environment, providing products that are real and authentic

Financial and Strategic Objectives

Financial:

Achieve monthly sales revenue of \$2,000 by the end of the first full semester (Fall 2026 semester)

Reach net income of \$10,000 by the end of the fiscal year

Control expense costs below 70% of total revenue as our shop is mainly going to be over a website and we take % per item sold

Strategic:

Expand to each Rutgers Campus (Newark and Camden expansions) by year end 2026

Reach an average of 100 customers monthly by the end of the fiscal year

Reach social media marketing accounts (Tiktok, Instagram, and Facebook) to 5,000 followers by the beginning of the fall semester

Corporate Social Responsibility Key Initiatives and Rationale

Community Give-Back Program: Donate unclaimed items to local nonprofits. Shows social responsibility, strengthens community relationships and counters negativity we could face.

Make sure our business is eco-friendly: Whether it be the transport method or the products we sell, we ensure everything is eco-friendly which is an easy way to show we care about that customer base.

Make sure our business is ethical and fair in our pricing: We're going to ensure our pricing is fair for students as most college students don't have money to be throwing around.

Description of New Product/Service selected by the team

A **bundle kit** for students coming into dorms might be a good venture for us to go into.

We can rely on

- Use items sold in the previous semester to create a bundled package for incoming students
- Have the bundle ready and set up before students arrive
- Saves students time by eliminating the need to shop for each item individually
- Offers added convenience, allowing for slightly higher pricing
- Ensures profitability while providing a streamlined experience for students



National expansion decision, approach, and rationale

Yes—Expanding nationally might be a major opportunity for us, we should wait at least till the end of the fall semester in the later 2026 before we consider expansion.

This:

- Allows time to test the business and gain hands-on experience
- Helps Learn the process at the end of spring semester and start of fall semester

We should wait to fully manage both key periods before expanding

- Expansion increases revenue and overall business value
- Scaling the Rutgers model to other universities unlocks broader market potential

Canada

Opportunities

- Very close
- Major university opportunities
- Similar legal system
- Stable economic environment (GDP growth and legal protection of IP)
- Very similar Power Distance and Uncertainty Avoidance score
 - 39-40 and 48-46, respectfully
 - Reduces cultural risk

Challenges

- Currency translation
- Language translation
- Strict interest rate caps
- Licensing requirements

Rationale

Canada's distance and similarity with the legal system mean that by far the best choice. The proximity means that we can still check the franchisees, which minimizes the risk of them causing us reputational damage since we are keeping an eye on them. It is most convenient as it has similar cultural conditions as America—they are close and speak same language, lots of legal enforcement, and not too much economic risk—which would mean we would require minimal changes in our business model.

Expansion strategy, Entry strategy, and rationale

Go Hybrid

Canada is very similar to America (very little customization needed), according to Hofstede's Dimensions of Culture

Cost savings, efficient, no major changes needed, and allows for consistent core business values (we could adjust for small changes in the marketplace, but nothing that would take away from our core business and vision)

Joint-Venture

We can join businesses and reduce financial risk. Doing so leads to more university connections, easier licensing and more minds as you now share a business.

Additionally if we were to do a joint venture with the colleges and campuses themselves, it would make integration that much easier (employees, promotional support, etc.)

Key job selected, summary of responsibilities, qualifications required, compensation plan, advertising plan, criteria for selection

Job: Store Clerk

Responsibilities:

- Answering customers questions
- Handling sales and giving change back (manages transactions)
- Has receipt of all sales
- Keep track of merchandise

Qualifications:

- No necessary qualifications required, preferred students to let them develop skills

Compensation Plan:

- Minimum wage

Advertising Plan:

- Rutgers platforms (Handshake)
- Job searching sites (LinkedIn, Indeed)
- Social Media
- Posters around campus

Criteria for Selection:

- Did the applicant provide a complete application
- Any prior retail, cash-handling, or customer service experience
- Provides a resume

Employee motivation initiatives

1. Flexible Scheduling
 - a. autonomy and work-life balance
2. Bi-Annual Salary Promotions
 - a. physiological needs, security, and growth
3. Anonymous Suggestion box
 - a. psychological safety and organizational belonging
4. Benefits (such as reserved parking)
 - a. convenience perks and general happiness
5. Employee of the Month (Praise as well as bonus)
 - a. extrinsic (money) and intrinsic (recognition) motivators

Key Employees Departure Announcement

Dear Current Employees,

It is with a heavy heart to announce the departure of two of our employees; however, to promote greater morale within the company, here are some of the benefits that staying with us provides.

We provide *flexible scheduling* to all employees—we understand many of you are students with busy schedules and we value your time and academics.

Another thing we are adding in the hopes that we never have to deal with these unfortunate departures again is *suggestion spots*. All of you will be able to provide *anonymous suggestions* for improvements or issues you see, and hopefully, you will never have to resign in order for your voice to be heard.

This job isn't without benefits either: by being a *loyal employee* of our business, you receive *campus privileges*, such as *free private parking* on campus lots and office perks.

Working hard pays off with us as employee of the month bonuses are provided. These bonuses can range from *wage increases, extra cash, public shoutouts*, and more. In addition to these benefits, a *raise every six-months* is expected for all of our employees.

With these, we hope for you to value our company and for us to not only gain your respect but your loyalty as well.

Kind Regards,

Your Boss

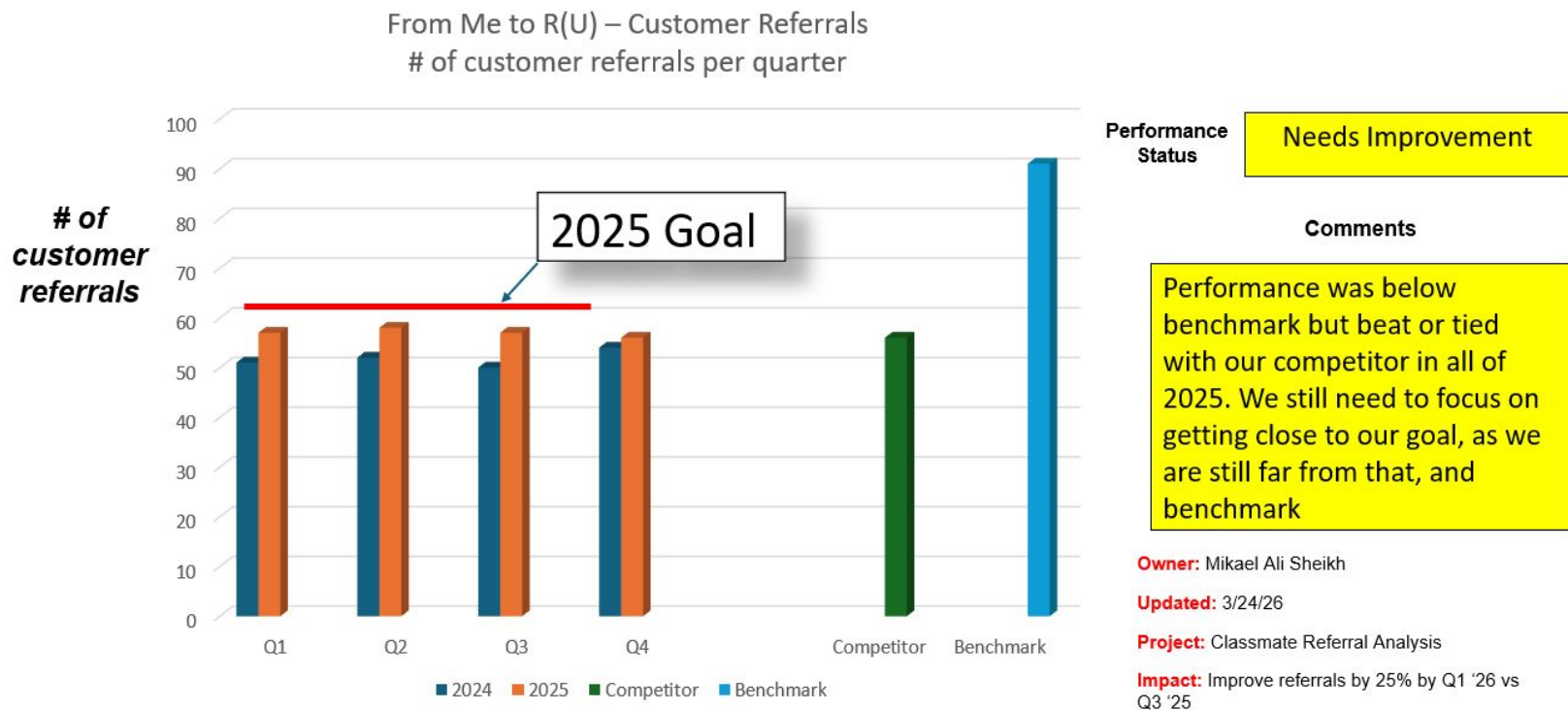
Key actions selected to achieve high levels of employee engagement

- Provide strong leadership and clear communication
- Offer professional opportunities
- Promote collaborative team culture
- We'd create formal and anonymous complaint system as well as a place for employees to provide constructive suggestions, allowing for their voices to be heard and be impactful
- We would provide employees with the authority and resources to start projects without management cues

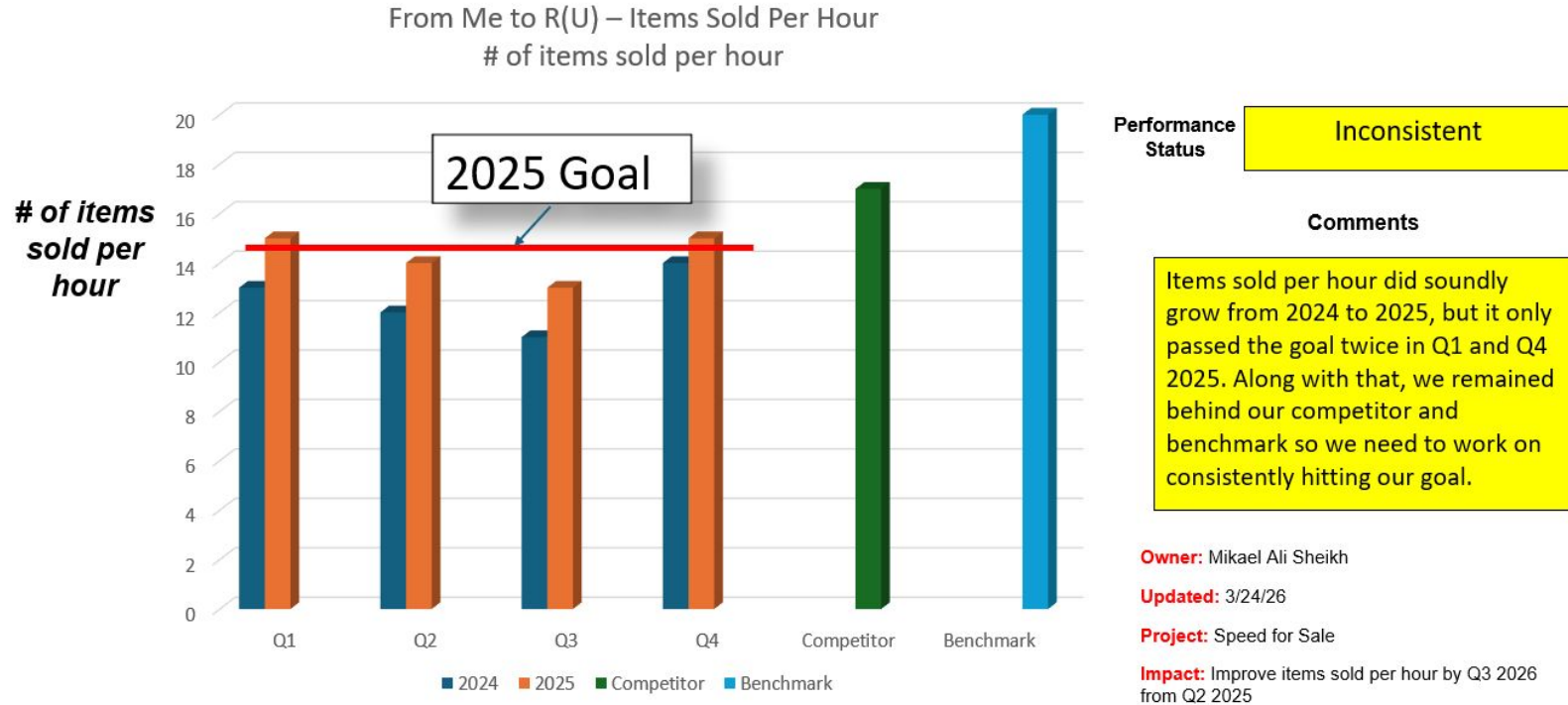
SIPOC

Suppliers	Inputs	Processes	Outputs	Customers
University Students Donators Alumni The University Local Labor Market Online Marketplace	Physical location with space to hold and advertise our goods Trained employees Marketing/ advertising Used goods	Collect/source inventory from suppliers Organize items and check quality Market the goods Sell quality items	Friendly service Good deals for items Quality goods that genuinely help Purchased inventory	Who: Rutgers Students Desired Customer Behaviors: - Repeated business - Referrals - High ratings - Infrequent returns Customer requirements: - Quality goods and accurate goods - Fair valued goods - Good service - Ease of purchase

Effectiveness Measurement Chart



Efficiency Measurement Chart



Key Initiative to Improve the Process

- Create an employee training program to help our employees on the sales floor get customers to make more purchases
 - Allows our employees to have training on how to increase sales while catering to our customers' needs and budget
- Pick up items from suppliers directly to get brand-new items in stock
 - This will add new inventory, exciting customers, and include a new input of suppliers, both of which will help get students who are weary on used items
- Adding a loyalty program, such as a membership club or punch cards with a discount after 10 visits
 - Gives us a way to show how we value our customers and give discounts to our loyal ones

To Sell, or Not to Sell

We Will Not Sell

While the agreement is attractive, and we have our stockholders to keep in mind,

- New owners have no experience or connection— its just a “fun” investment
- CSR commitments won't be upheld
- Risk for our customers, employees, suppliers, and business partners
 - Loss of jobs, poor leadership, etc.

Summary of Success

Our business has succeeded through our efforts of bridging the gap between convenience and community. Through the convenience and accessibility of our products, the trust and authenticity of our brand, our proven growth and performance, as well as our commitment to our community and our social responsibility, we have proven our success as a company and provided strong enough roots to expand beyond.